

Exercise 31: Plane Crash Survival

Introduction:

This exercise enables student groups to discover how they work together; their strengths and how they need to improve.

Evaluation:

Students will be utilizing the problem solving process, group and team dynamics, followership and leadership. As an evaluator, you can choose to evaluate a team as a whole, or assign a leader of each group and evaluate them.

Explanation:

- You and your companions have just survived the crash of a small plane.
- Both the pilot and co-pilot were killed in the crash.
- It is mid-January, and you are in Northern Canada.
- The daily temperature is 25 below zero, and the night time temperature is 40 below zero.
- There is snow on the ground, and the countryside is wooded with several creeks criss-crossing the area.
- The nearest town is 20 miles away.
- You are all dressed in city clothes appropriate for a business meeting.
- Your group of survivors managed to salvage the following items:

1. A ball of steel wool
2. A small axe
3. A loaded .45-caliber pistol
4. Can of Crisco shortening
5. Newspapers (one per person)
6. Cigarette lighter (without fluid)
7. Extra shirt and pants for each survivor
8. 20 x 20 ft. piece of heavy-duty canvas
9. A sectional air map made of plastic
10. One quart of 100-proof whiskey
11. A compass
12. Family-size chocolate bars (one per person)

Scenarios:

- One cadet has a bleeding open fracture on their left leg , another has a bleeding head wound.
- There is a large black bear approaching.
- Cadets are starting to shiver violently and early signs of frostbite are starting to show.
- The compass doesn't work because it was near a magnet in the plane. (or stops working? If they are using it to navigate)
- The cadet in charge suddenly collapses from hypothermia.
- The sun is setting and your group needs to rest, but it is -40 degrees.

Discussion Questions:

1. Importance of using a deputy/ adapting - Was a deputy used? Did cadets step up quickly to fill leadership roles when someone was taken out? Were they able to adapt to constantly changing ROEs/ situations?
2. Was communication effective? Could it be improved on?
3. Were the supplies used effectively? Was anything not used that could've been helpful? Was anything from the environment used?
4. Is there any outside knowledge that could be useful to know/ "have in your back pocket"?
5. If you could redo this scenario, what would you do differently?